

on the ground in ramallah

reports from a town become battlefield

On Tuesday 24th September, Israel opened an alleged "Second Temple" tunnel that connects to a cistern (where access will be permitted) that runs under al-Haram al-Sharif (the whole area of the "Temple Mount"), the site of the Dome of the Rock and Al-Aqsa Mosque, the world's third most holy site for Muslims. Palestinian President Yasser Arafat announced a national strike for the following day and the West Bank and Gaza Strip erupted with angry demonstrations.

This protest was about much more than the opening of a tunnel, one in [a long line of Israeli attempts to present Jerusalem to the world as a purely Jewish city](#). The protest was the result of utter Palestinian disillusionment about the peace process, that has been carried out with disregard for Palestinian rights, first by the Israeli Labour government and more recently, by the Netanyahu-led Likud government.

The demonstrations developed into a battle between Israeli and Palestinian troops. This website offers news and photographs from the area of Ramallah, a central West Bank Palestinian town that has become a battlefield.

Click here for news and photographs from [on the ground in Ramallah](#)

[Website and related material from Birzeit University staff](#)

High resolution photos available by request.

Contact nparry@admin.birzeit.edu.



on the ground in ramallah

reports from a town become battlefield

The first day

On Wednesday, September 25 ... things blew up.

BY MARWAN TARAZI, DIRECTOR, BIRZEIT UNIVERSITY COMPUTER CENTER

There is only so much that one people can take. On Wednesday September 25, 1996, things blew up. I was in my office at Birzeit University that morning when the loud speakers began to wail. Students were trying to voice their anger and frustration about the opening of the now-infamous tunnel underneath the third holiest Islamic site. A strike was declared at the university in protest and busses were called in to shuttle students to Al Aqsa mosque where they could pray.

The news of the opening of the tunnel below and beside Al Aqsa mosque came in early Tuesday morning. The tunnel had been opened in the middle of the night "to avoid the heat of the day," an Israeli spokesman claimed. The opening of this tunnel is one more aggravation, one more humiliation, ... one violation too many for the Palestinian people. This is also Al Aqsa, the third holiest site in Islam. The "pressure cooker" that everyone has been talking about for so long began to explode. The "Peace" Accords that were supposed to bring peace to the area have been nothing more than a disappointing and humiliating experience for Palestinians.

Just outside Ramallah, on the way to Jerusalem, the students' busses were stopped by the Israeli army, and the students were prevented from passing through the Israeli checkpoint separating Areas A (areas controlled by the Palestinian Authority) and Area C (areas controlled by the Israeli authorities). Clashes broke out--students began throwing rocks, and the Israeli army started using rubber bullets--scores of students were injured by these bullets.

As the ambulances began to pour into the heart of Ramallah carrying the injured students, residents from the surrounding areas rushed in to join the protesting students. ...Then a molotov cocktail was thrown at the Israeli army. According to Israeli army regulations "once a molotov cocktail is used, the army is allowed to use live ammunition to protect itself".

The army opened fire with live ammunition, and scores more Palestinian protesters were injured. Then a Palestinian policeman manning a post near the Area A/Area C divider was hit with a live bullet. This is when the Palestinian police and army began to fire back. "I could not sit back and watch my friends and brothers getting razed by the Israelis and do nothing about it," one Palestinian soldier later told me.

Once the news of the fighting in Ramallah spread, fighting between Palestinians and the Israeli army

on the ground in ramallah

reports from a town become battlefield

PHOTO DIARY

BY NIGEL PARRY

WITH PHOTOS BY NIGEL PARRY, YASSER DARWEESH
KIFAH AL-FANI AND SALEEM DAOUD

Last updated: 11:50am Palestinian time, 12 October 1996. Links to Cobra Helicopter information added
Please excuse the spelling mistakes and other typos. These will be rectified soon!

Day 1: Wednesday 25th September 1996

- [Rally at Birzeit University](#)
- [Demonstration at the Khamara Checkpoint](#) (updated 29/9/96)
- [Israeli soldiers open fire](#) (updated 29/9/96)
- [Casualties](#)
- [Aftermath of the first shootings](#)
- [At the hospital](#) (Some images may be disturbing)
- [Intensive care unit](#) (Some images may be disturbing) (new 30/9/96)

Day 2: Thursday 26th September 1996

- [The seriousness of things](#) (new 6/10/96)
- [At Khamara Checkpoint in the late afternoon](#)
- [The face of war](#)
- [Palestinian Police confront Israeli snipers](#) (new 6/10/96)
- [Helicopter gunships open fire on homes](#) (updated 29/9/96)
- [Ammunition used](#) (new 6/10/96)

Day 3: Friday 27th September 1996

- [Tanks surround Ramallah](#) (new 30/9/96)
- [Midday around Khamara checkpoint](#) (new 30/9/96, updated 1/10/96)
- [Stone throwing at Khamara checkpoint](#) (new 30/9/96)
- [Casualties at Khamara checkpoint](#) (Some images may be disturbing) (new 30/9/96, updated 1/10/96)

Photo Diary

Day 1: Wednesday 25th September 1996, "Demonstration at Khamara Checkpoint"



Students joined with many other Ramallans after they were prevented from travelling to Jerusalem, both groups numbering around 800 in total. *Photo by Yasser Darweesh*



A burning tire rolls towards an Israeli soldier. *Photo by Yasser Darweesh*

ABOUT THIS
WEBSITE

ON THE
GROUND IN
RAMALLAH

THE MARTYR
IN SOCIETY

PERSONAL
STORIES

HOW YOU
CAN HELP



Featured stories



Abu Khalid, our pens are incapable of writing, our minds are incapable of thinking, and our tongues are incapable of speech. If we fill the sea with ink, it would not be enough to write how great you were in life. I won't cry for you because you are not dead inside me. My memories of you live on.

I waited for Tammam there but started to worry and phoned him on his mobile. A stranger's voice answered me telling me that the owner of this mobile was lying in the hospital. I arrived at the hospital to discover that he was dead. I uncovered him. Looked at him. Touched him. He was warm and I kissed him. He was my angel."



Amin used to say to his friends, "Why do we live amongst stones, bullets and blood? Why do we have no independence and never know safety and security? We live amongst wild soldiers, destruction and martyrs. Are we ever going to live a happy life?"

One soldier took aim and shot Yasser from a distance of 20m. Live ammunition lodged in his heart and he was rushed to the hospital where they operated on him in a corridor in an attempt to save his life. He was placed in intensive care. He was the first person shot and the last to die, four months later in a Jordanian hospital on the 6th February 1997.



As you browse the website listen to [Al-Kellimat Al-Abira \("Passing Words"\)](#), a poem by Mahmoud Darweesh with music by Samieh Shkir in [Real Audio](#) format. A [translation](#) is available here. To take full advantage of the Java features of this website or if you are experiencing display problems, make sure you are browsing with the latest version of [Netscape Navigator](#) or [Microsoft Internet Explorer](#).

About this website

This website was set up by a group of Palestinians and internationals living in the West Bank and Gaza Strip, with coordination by Birzeit University's Public Relations Office. The website is intended to show the human face behind the statistics of the September 1996 clashes.

On the Ground in Ramallah

The website put together by Birzeit staff and students during the clashes last year, that offered daily reports from "on the ground" in Ramallah, the town become battlefield.

The Martyr in Society

ABOUT THIS
WEBSITE

ON THE
GROUND IN
RAMALLAH

THE MARTYR
IN SOCIETY

PERSONAL
STORIES

HOW YOU
CAN HELP



PERSONAL STORIES

"My homeland is Palestine"

Amin Mohammed Jabr Barbakh, "Mandela", aged 17, Khan Younis
Refugee Camp, Gaza Strip.

Right: Amin

Amin was born to a very poor family in Khan Younis Refugee Camp in the Gaza Strip. His family of seven lived in a one room house with Amin the only breadwinner in the family.

Due to his family's difficulties, he decided to quit school early and find work. His father had heart disease and was unable to support the family. Amin bought a few goods and worked as a peddler, selling his goods near the medical centre in the camp. The district where Amin used to work was known as *Mandela*. He admired Nelson Mandela very much as a prisoner of conscience, and he took the nickname *Mandela*.

Within the camp Amin was known for his generosity. The medical staff of the clinic tell how he never refused to help them in any way. He used to help the patients in the clinic with their medicines and help them fill out their medical forms. In the afternoon he would come back home, put his sports clothes on, and play football with his friends. He was the goalkeeper in the team.

He loved soccer dearly and dreamt of becoming a professional player. He supported the Egyptian team "Al Ahli" and his uncle, who was the coach of his team, supported "Ez Zamalik" (another Egyptian team). Whenever Al Ahli beat Ez Zamalik he would buy some sweets and give them to his uncle.

His uncle says "Once we were training and I asked Mandela to change with another player. He refused, I insisted and again he refused and not thinking I slapped him in the face. Amin paused and didn't say a word, but his eyes were full of tears and he ran home. In the evening I went to his house and told him I want you to become a professional but you have to rest. You can't play all the time. I apologised, then he kissed me and said: "Forget it. What can I do? This is football."



بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم



For coverage on "Intifadat Al-Aqsa" and the struggle in Palestine, visit these sites.



Come, let me tell you about Palestine

كما الشمسُ تؤوّل إلى الغروب فإن النصر حتماً للشـ

صفحة الشهيد علاء البرغوثي Site of Martyr Alaa Barghouthi



P.R.C.S

Palestine Red Crescent Society

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
وَالْحَسْبُ الْغَنِيُّ قَاتِلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ أَمْوَالُكُمْ أَحَبُّ إِلَيْكُمْ مِنْ رِقَابِكُمْ
وَالَّذِينَ قَاتَلُوا فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَمَاتُوا أَوْ قُتِلُوا أُولَئِكَ هُمُ الصَّالِحُونَ



[Click here to go to the main page](#)

BEIT REMA MASSACRE 24-25/Oct 2001

The Martyr Raed Al-Barghouthi (Alaa's first cousin)



intefadet al-qa



updated daily list of martyrs
urgent funds are needed for medical relife
al-intefadah news





[see Palestinian children photos](#)

[see special photos from palestine](#)



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

We kindly ask you to pray "Al Fatiha"
in memory of the blessed martyr souls

Al Fatiha



Al Fatiha



Al Fatiha

Home

... KOLUNA MOQAWAMA ...

THE LIONS OF ISLAMIC MOQAWAMA IN THE SOUTH OF LEBANON

~ * HIZBULLAH * ~

جنوب الكرامة والشعب العنيد



Know! Who Made The Victory ... Martyrs of The Islamic Resistance
Arabic English

See The Man Who Defeated Israel

Mubarak .. Hizbullah .. Arabic



The Beloved Land "FALESTINE"

The Flower of Cities "AL-QUDS"

The Holy Mosque "AL-AQSA"

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ
سُبْحَنَ الَّذِي أَسْرَى بِعَبْدِهِ لَيْلًا مِنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ
الْأَقْصَا الَّذِي بَنَى حَوْلَهُ لِنُرْيَاهُ مِنْ آيَاتِنَا إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْبَصِيرُ



See and Read Some Facts About Palestine, al-Quds and al-Aqsa

- [Facts About Israeli Terrorism and More ...](#)
- [Did You Know? 20 Basic Facts About Palestine](#)
- [Survey of Israeli Acts of Aggression Against al-Aqsa](#)
- [Massacres Against Palestinians](#)
- [Few Facts About The Occupation of Golan](#)
- [Crimes Against Humanity - Destroyed Villages Taken From Jerusalemites Site.](#)
- [Palestine From The Viewpoint of Imam Khomeini](#)
- [Some Sayings of Imam Khomeini About al-Quds, Israel and USA](#)
- [al-Quds: The Focus of Muslims Grief](#)

أخبار عاجلة

PDF القدس

القدس أمس

الصفحة الأولى

أخبار محلية

مقالات

كاريكاتير

بريد القدس

هوية القدس

الوفيات



غزة - صبيان يركضون للإحتماء بعد أن فتحت دبابة اسلؤيلية النار نحوهم خلال مواجهات قرب مستوطنة نتساريم امس

تجدد القصف الاسرائيلي للاحياء السكنية والمواقع الامنية
ثلاثة شهداء وعشرات الجرحى في الضفة والقطاع
والحصار المشدد يزداد ضراوة على المدن والقرى والمخيمات

بوش: نريد بن لادن حيا او ميتا...!!

امريكاني حالة تاهب قصوى وتخشى

مزيذا من العمليات

البنتاغون يطلب من الفيلق ١٨ وحاملات الطائرات
الاستعداد للانتشار

حذرت من وصول الارهاب الى الاسلحة النووية

الولايات المتحدة تخشى هجوما

كيميا نيا او جرثوميا...!!

في رسالة تهنئة وجهها للاسرائيليين

بمناسبة السنة العبرية الجديدة

الرئيس عرفات: اصدرت تعليمات حازمة

لوقف اطلاق النار

نأمل من حكومتكم اتخاذ قرار مماثل ووقف التصعيد

ضد شعبنا ومدننا ومخيماتنا

ولي عهد السعودية يؤكد دعم بلاده

لشعبنا وسلطته الوطنية

رسالة هامة من الرئيس عرفات الى بوش تتعلق

بالاوضاع الصعبة في الاراضي الفلسطينية



[Click Here]

wap.alquds.com/

travel



MIRROR SITE

www.alquds2.com

For Local Users

مرسالة من الأرض المحتلة

Francais

الأخبار

أحداث

القدس

رأبك

News

Gallery

Jerusalem

Your Opinion

[PAISOFT](#)

Fc 95401

cooperation with

PBC [Voice of Palestine](#)

© Copyright 2000
[DM](#)
[All rights reserved](#)



JERUSALEM

THE HOLY LAND



Stop Killing People In the HOLLY LAND

A shout From the Heart Of Palestine

We are appealing from Palestine to the whole world. We are trying to reach to your hearts from Palestine, where land is sown by blood of innocent people and children, who are killed for defending their land and the holly places . We are here to tell you about this massacre. Israeli soldiers are murdering our children. Isn't it a human slaughter, which is being shamelessly executed by those who claim to be the victims of Holocaust?...

Al-Aqsa is calling for all the Muslems who are swimming in their long dreams , which lasted for more than 50 years , to the whole world to all who respect the human rights, we would like to see your movements in this way, stop looking , move now toward the holly city , to Al-aqsa, the church of Nativity and all the holly places in this wonderful city .

Our blood river will go on till we return Al-Aqsa & the Dome Of the Rock, to be in Islamic safty hands, no Killers pointing their weapons towards prayers , to bring the peace to the city of peace .

What happened on Friday Sep 30,2000



Click to enlarge

[Home](#)

GALLERY

[Home](#)

ISRAEL TRUTH

Tears

No Fear

Weapons

Wounds

Population

Cartoon

Children



What Kind Of People They Are.



**What ever happen we will stay on
like one part**

A nation deserve a life



*A
l
l*



*R
e
s
p
e
c
t*



*M
Y*



*P
E
O
P
L
E*





[Main Page](#)

[Home](#)

